

Colophony



What is it?

Colophony is a sticky substance derived from tree sap. It comes from pine trees but also from cedars, spruce, firs and junipers. Abietic acid is the major component of colophony and also most responsible for allergy. Colophony is used in a variety of products including adhesives and waxes, and it is added to paper to increase its water resistance. It is also often used as a protective coating.

COLOPHONY can also be known as:

- Colophonium
- Rosin or resin, rosin gum
- Gum, wood, and pine rosin
- Resin terebinthinae
- Tall oil

Other components or derivatives are:

- Abietic acid and abietyl alcohol, abitol
- Dehydroabietic acid, dihydroabietic acid
- Methyl abietate alcohol
- Glyceryl abietate
- Triethylene glycol rosinate
- Glyceryl hydrogenated rosinate

Some Possible Uses of COLOPHONY / Where it might be found:

- Adhesive, tape, and bandages
- Medicated plaster and wart tape
- Collodion and Opsite
- Hydrocolloid dressing
- Ostomy appliances
- Medicated first aid ointment
- Cold sore, fever blister cream
- Hemorrhoid cream
- Chinese medicine

- Glazing agent for pills
- Dental floss, cement, impression paste, and temporary prosthesis
- Root canal antiseptic, sealant
- Fluoride tooth varnish, periodontal dressing
- Gum
- Depilatory and hair removal wax
- Makeup and nail polish
- Hair spray, pomade
- Sunscreen
- Disposable diapers and sanitary napkins
- Transparent or yellow bar soap
- Laundry detergent, pre wash
- Grease remover
- Fabric sizing/yarn coating
- Marking pen ink (i.e. permanent markers), ceramic ink, printing ink
- Modeling clay
- Tissue, newsprint, paper pulp, paper sizing
- Cardboard and recycled paper products
- Glossy / photo paper, price labels
- Cigarette filters and paper
- Postage stamp adhesive, sticker adhesive
- Rubber cement, glue, mastic, sealing wax
- Glue for shoe, boot, and slipper insoles or soles
- Linoleum, floor tile, and carpet adhesive
- Electrical or thermal insulating tape, jointing tape
- Sticky fly paper and fly strips
- Rosin for ballet, flamenco, boxer shoes
- Rosin for violin, viola, cello, and bass violin
- Grip aid (gymnastics, rock climbing), ski wax
- Leather cleaner and lubricant
- Pine oil cleaner, pine/spruce sawdust, pine pencil

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Colophony



- Firewood, pitch, match tips, and fireworks
- Paint, lacquer, varnish, rust proof coating
- Waterproof surface coating, brewery pitch
- Furniture and floor polish and stain
- Shoe polish and shoe wax
- Car wax, metal polish, and gasket shellac
- Plasticizer for rubber, fabric, or oil cloth
- Asphalt, tire compounding, and reclaiming
- Caulk, putty, wood filler, and construction gap filler
- Soldering flux / agent, joint compound
- Corrosion inhibitor, office machine lubricant
- Cutting fluid and oil, core oil, tall oil
- Axle grease and lubricant thickener
- Machine belt tackifier
- Hoof salve, diuretic, and dog repellent
- Coffee bean polish
- Tattoo ink

Other products that may cross react with COLOPHONY:

- Balsam of Peru and fragrances
- Oils, spices, turpentine
- Propolis
- Chrysanthemum family plants

What should I do to avoid COLOPHONY?

Use only products that do not contain any of the names above. Check the ingredients of each product used at home.

To look for exposure at work, check the Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS). Common sources of colophony (i.e. a wood derived item) often do not have material safety data sheets.

Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's or store's

website. When handling paper or cardboard, wear cotton gloves. Wear latex, nitrile, or vinyl gloves for cleaning or repair.

Safe alternatives to COLOPHONY or ROSIN:

- To increase friction, try chalk or ZeaSorb
- Instead of scotch tape, try Elmer's Glue All
- Colophony free tape: Dermicel, Micropore, Scanpor, and Band Aid Sheer Strips
- Instead of epilating wax, try a depilatory cream or lotion. Or, try sugar wax
- Cloth diapers / pads: www.diaperware.com and www.allnaturalmamas.com

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

REVISION DATE: JANUARY 2026

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